



Travel & Adventure

10 Must-Visit UNESCO World Heritage Sites in China

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10 Must-Visit UNESCO World Heritage Sites in China

China has 57 UNESCO World Heritage Sites -- the most in the world alongside Italy. Here are the top 10 that every traveler should experience.

1. The Great Wall (长城)

-- Beijing area

Over 21,000 km of ancient fortifications. Best sections: Mutianyu (restored, less crowded), Jinshanling (photography), Badaling (most accessible). Entry: ¥40-65. Open 7:30 AM - 5:30 PM.

2. Terracotta Army (兵马俑)

-- Xi'an

Over 8,000 life-size warrior sculptures from 210 BC, guarding Emperor Qin Shi Huang's



mausoleum. Three excavation pits open to visitors. Entry: ¥120. Allow 3-4 hours.

3. Forbidden City (故宫)

-- Beijing

600-year-old imperial palace with 9,999 rooms across 72 hectares. The world's largest palace complex. Entry: ¥60 (Apr-Oct), ¥40 (Nov-Mar). Book tickets online in advance.

4. West Lake (西湖)

-- Hangzhou

Inspired countless poems and paintings. Cycle around the lake, visit Leifeng Pagoda, take a boat to Three Pools Mirroring the Moon. Free entry to the lake area.

5. Zhangjiajie National Forest Park

-- Hunan



The inspiration for Avatar's floating mountains. Glass bridge, cable cars, and stunning sandstone pillars. Entry: ¥225 (4-day pass).

6. Jiuzhaigou Valley

-- Sichuan

Crystal-clear turquoise lakes, multi-tiered waterfalls, and snow-capped peaks. Best in autumn (Oct-Nov) for spectacular foliage. Entry: ¥169-250.

7. Mount Huangshan (黄山)

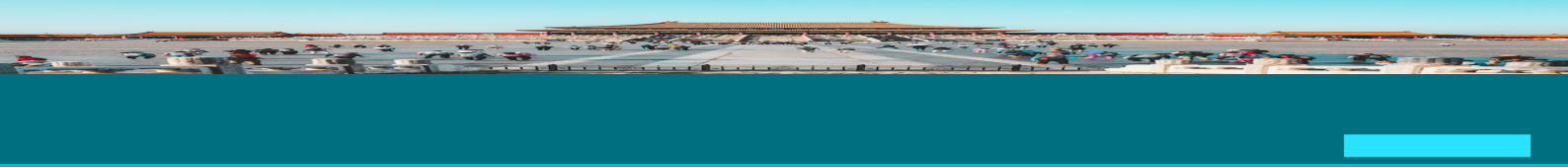
-- Anhui

Famous for granite peaks, hot springs, and sea-of-clouds formations. Sunrise at Bright

Summit Peak is legendary. Cable car: ¥80-90. Entry: ¥190.

8. Potala Palace

-- Lhasa, Tibet



Iconic 7th-century palace at 3,700m altitude. Former residence of the Dalai Lama. Entry:

¥200 (May-Oct), ¥100 (Nov-Apr). Requires Tibet Travel Permit.

9. Lijiang Old Town

-- Yunnan

800-year-old town of the Naxi minority with cobblestone streets, canals, and traditional

wooden architecture. Entry: ¥50 (ancient city maintenance fee).

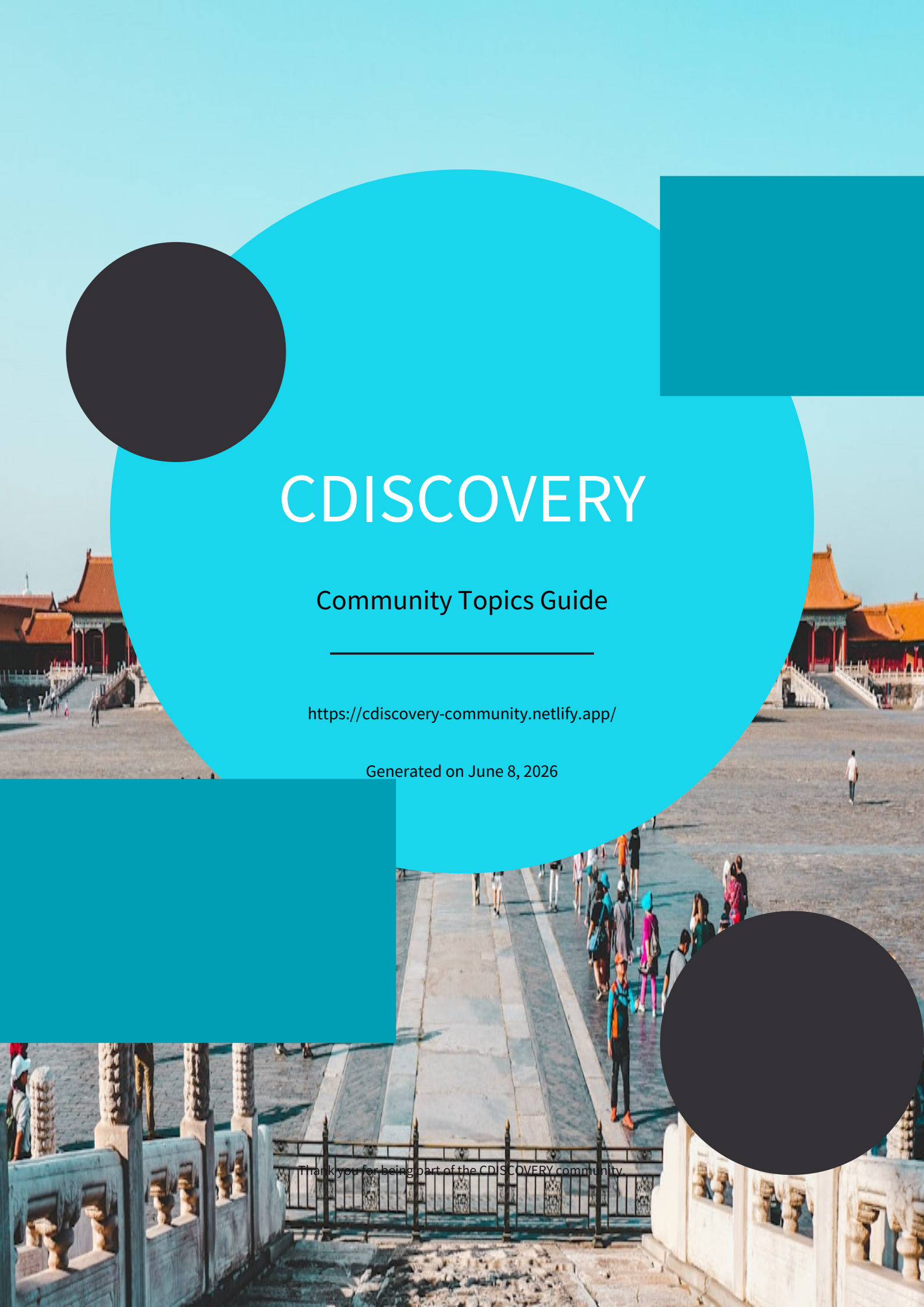
10. Chengdu Research Base of Giant Panda Breeding

-- Sichuan

See giant pandas and red pandas in a natural habitat setting. Best visited early morning

(8-10 AM) when pandas are most active. Entry: ¥55.

Sources: Sources: [China National Tourism Administration](http://www.cnta.gov.cn) • [UNESCO World Heritage Centre](https://whc.unesco.org)



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